Ajahn Sumedho - Don’t Take It Personally (2000)

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convention, compulsive, feeling, trust, awareness, refuge, change, ideals, shoulds, pure, thinking, attitude, buddha, condition, good, read, practice, form, personality, ideas

SPEAKERS

Ajahn Sumedho

Ajahn Sumedho 00:02
No more tensor Vega word torah heard took some some more tests and more tests serve a wide toe. Hara had took some, some voters and more Bhagawan to her heard her some, some voters have heard or de sang matassa Tawana yay soda one moon juntos Tada

Ajahn Sumedho 00:50
this is the observance nights and half moon waning waning moon and tomorrow's a Equinox autumn and last quarter of the year 2000 will be it'd be history like 1999 was now history memory

Ajahn Sumedho 01:37
we have just three weeks left of the masa that these are perceptions of time change on their own the conditioned realm of convention like Vasa is a convention the this the autumn that doesn't say I'm automated we call it autumn autumn equinox and so this is a convention that we we use for communication for a moral agreements or cultural attitudes that we all subscribe to or use for our conventional reality and then Bara Manta Sansa is ultimate reality where this is where we, we get in beyond a convention with the conventions are made, they're made up, they're dependent on other things. Things that are considered good in one conventional form are considered appropriate in another and that we have various bye biases and prejudices that we get through culture and through the conventions that we have

Ajahn Sumedho 03:14
noticed in in living in Europe, isn't it we have just the old biases of what french french are like in Germans and Italians and so forth. We have you know, cultural attitudes, that way of perceiving these things that we form these these various opinions, views. That's why it's easy to to have, like ethnic warfare and race prejudices and class Class snobbery and that was because we we never question the conventional reality that we've adopted, we, we we just go along with it. So then we we do we hold you know, various views about our religion, in our race in our culture and, and then compare it to somebody

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else's. And then on that level, then we there's nothing but you know, we try to we have ideals now say of democracy and equality and all that, but we're still very much influenced by the conventional realities that we're conditioned by. It takes quite a determined effort to get beyond your cultural conditioning. Like being the American you think, you know, you think brought up in here there's a lot there. Do Just assume make assumptions from like, I never realized how arrogant I could be till I had delivered another culture or I never saw how you know how the American idealism couldn't be another blind spot. You know, it could be like shoving our ideas down everybody's throats Asian Americans knows what's good for everybody how they should run their countries. And yet, when you're brought up to think that, that you know, we're somehow the most advanced and no more than you That's an assumption and I don't think that was taught in any intentional way it was assumed it was an underlying attitudes

Ajahn Sumedho 05:57
so the when you're to get beyond these easy as assumptions, things we pick out when and if we don't even know that we're that we that we have these attachments still reflected in some way these these biases. So, that's why living in different cultures isn't it helps for one thing, you know, you you find like going to live in Thailand helped me to see a lot of these things because the culture was so different. And then the whole attitude was in living in a Buddhist monastery. So the emphasis was on reflection and mindfulness and wisdom. So, I just wasn't becoming a kind of ersatz Thai or in or just going native as they say it was learning to see what you know the the subtleties of attitude and assumption that that one is conditioned by that may not be all that easily seen until you find yourself suffering about something

Ajahn Sumedho 07:32
the one of the the the problems that we have in in Haven meditation is this kind of compulsive compulsiveness. Our society is a very, it's a very, we're brought up to be very kind of obsessed. And, and compulsive, there's so many shoulds when you're coming from ideas, from from ideas and ideals, and there's, the result of that is, oh, there's so many shoulds in your vocabulary, how things should be. And so, it's this, this idealism is, you know, as its beauty, not to discard it, but to recognize it limitation, that, this feeling that there's always something we've got to do, there's something we haven't done yet that we should be doing. We should be working harder than then we're working, we should be practicing more than we're practicing, we should be more honest than we are, we should be more open, we should be more devout and we should be better natured and oh, no, like, that's only true, you know, the shoulds are usually right. You know, in terms of, you know, if things were perfect, then I wouldn't would be you know, everything would be just perfect, you know, I'd be an ideal in life, society would be ideal Amravati would fit the idea we'd all be perfect. And so then you could then there's nothing more you should do because you've already reached the top. But that's not the way live is. An idea is something we create, isn't it? It's it's like you take your ideas from the best or what's the most kind of beautiful or perfect or fair or just

Ajahn Sumedho 09:53
the Buddha is pointing to the way life is the way it is, which is its change. genius, it doesn't stick at the best, doesn't it? You can't, you can't hold anything. And it's just contemplating flowers, for example, you know, like roses, you get that you get perfect rose when it was just at its peak, you know, it's just absolutely perfect in its form its color its fragrance. But you can't keep it that way. And blast that way

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very briefly, and suddenly, it all starts going the other way. And then you just want to get rid of it, throw it out and get another one. So the like with mindfulness, we're aware of this changing this the way things change. And, therefore the observer observe in terms of our own experience of meditation, being aware of how things changed, like, like moods and feeling. This the, when we when we think of how things should be, then then we get back into ideas again, and then compare yourself to, to maybe ideas that we have, what practices, what good practices, how many hours a day, you should sit and meditation, how, you know how you should do this, how you should do that, and, on and on, like this, to where we can operate from these ideas that you know, which are oftentimes very good ideas. But the problem is, even if you perform according to all the shoulds, then the then you never, there's always something more, there's always something that should be better than this or it goes on, you're never get to the root of the problem because you just go on and on and the to where there's, there's always this feeling, there's something more you've got to do something you should be doing. And when we reach the end, it doesn't we'd give up sometimes anything, I just had enough of this, to hell with it. I'm just going to enjoy life in this realm, and just go and have a good time and heat drink make merry til I die, is because one can only be driven so far. And then then it just your, your you can't sustain it. You know, it doesn't work anymore

Ajahn Sumedho 12:59
so the Yes, I mean to listen to the like should is, is a fair enough, you know, way to think about something, not. Some people think we shouldn't even think should. But, but it meant to recognize how things affect us. You know, like just noticing the feeling, there's always something more I have to do. For example, that story about this recurring dream I used to have when I first went to stay with low GPA. And I'd been in 63 9060, I finished my master's degree in Berkeley and, and that was a year of just, you know, really compulsive and intense studying. Were everything, I couldn't enjoy anything because every time I you know, went out and and tried to enjoy myself, I'm thinking oh, you've got your exam coming in, you know, you got to pass your master's degree and and so you know, go to a party or try to relax and then this voice and say you shouldn't be here you know, you've got to take this exam and you're not ready. You're not good enough for it then. And so you know, that whole year I couldn't enjoy anything just driving myself in. And after I finished the the masters. I couldn't read a book for about six months after that. Mind just couldn't concentrate. I just couldn't. I went through Peace Corps training in Hawaii after that. And they want me to read all these things. I couldn't read them. I couldn't even read the instructions. And they're just like all Reloaded, you know. But that left that kind of intensity of the way I would approach anything would be either can't do it and just give up totally or get into the old compulsive mode. So then when I, you know, when I went to David Lang punch Cha, I kept having this recurring G because I put a lot of effort into my practice meditation practice. This dream, when I be under is bigger, the context would be, I'd be going into like, a cafe or a coffee shop, I'd sit down order a cup of coffee, and, you know, nice pastry. And then the voice would say, You shouldn't be here, you should be studying for the exam. And that would be the, the kind of recurring theme of the dream. And this dream kept, you know, it was, I'd have it quite often wasn't a one off, and I have to think, what's it telling me, and then my compulsive mind kept thinking, There's something I'm not doing that I should be doing. In I should be practicing more, I should be more mindful, I should be. I shouldn't be sleeping so much. I wasn't sleeping hardly at all actually.

Ajahn Sumedho 16:34

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Kept, you know, kept thinking that this was a message telling me that somehow, you know, I'm, I am, there's something I'm doing that I are not doing that I should be doing. And so I kept trying to think what could it be, you know, I couldn't drive myself any more than what I'm doing. And you know, it just didn't, I couldn't figure it out. And then then one morning, I had this dream, I woke up and I had the answer. And the answer was, there wasn't any examination. Just realized that I live my life always, like I was going to be tested or brought before the authorities and put to a test. And that I was never ready. I mean, never good enough. There's always more, I could study more, I could read more, I couldn't do things more. I shouldn't be lazy, and I shouldn't enjoy life, because it this is this is wasting my time. Because the exams coming and I'm not ready for. And it was a whole kind of emotional conditioning than I'd acquired because the the school systems in the states are very competitive. You start when you're five years old. And you just keep going. So once I had saw that this was the, you know, I had that insight that there wasn't any that I just thought there was and I had always lived my life, most of my life in this attitude that that that there was going to be a big test that I wasn't prepared for. And maybe it was also from my religious background where you've got you know, you're going to be tested when you die, you go to the gates and then whether they let you in or not. You know, whether you've been good enough to go to heaven or or you have to go down to hell. No, so this is always a sense of is if you've got to do something, there isn't the you're not good enough. You're imperfect. I'm imperfect. I'm I have too many faults, I've got to get rid of them. I've got to become something that I'm not I shouldn't the way I am is not good enough. And, and so that this this driven quality, bringing it into monastic life, you know, I I could you know, I could do it for a while but then I realized that if I was going to be a monk I didn't want to have to live you know, that wasn't the purpose of the life and and it wasn't meant to be that way. It was just how I was just interpreting monasticism in my with it with this compulsive problem so I stopped having the dream once I got the answer to the to the riddle so then thinking You know, when when you really contemplate the Dharma in like, this morning, I was talking about the three first three fetters like Sakaya, dt, the personality view, we acquire this when we're born, we're not born with the personality view isn't something we acquire. And of course, you can see when you're brought up in a very competitive system, you, you have you, you see yourself in terms of the comparing yourself to others and to ideals, all the time, your value your worth is, is very much related to what's considered the best. And who's the best. And if you're not, if you don't fit into the best category, then you oftentimes see yourself in terms of, you know, not being good enough. And even people who see who I used to think were the best don't usually think of themselves as the best. Sometimes we think some people are much happier than that, then because we project onto them, we think they're better off than we are.

Ajahn Sumedho 21:19
But when the Buddha emphasized mindfulness as the way then this is pointing to the way things are rather than to the best. So when they used to read these in the morning, and what by polling, they'd have the reading. And they'd read these excerpts from suitors about, you know, what bhikkhu should be, and, and they were all according to the ideals of what a good bhikkhu is. And so, you know, this was, how to interpret this because of wanting to be that feeling of having to live up to such high standards, also was a feeling of, you know, can't Can I, you know, just can I really do all that, you know, is it one can just feel so kind of discouraged or despairing because you're looking at it in terms of ideals. But then the teachings of the Buddha isn't, isn't based on ideals, but on dhamma the way things are, I mean, like in Vipassana, you're really, you know, tuning in to, to impermanence, to tragedy to a nature which is, it's not a matter of how things should be, it's the way they are in all condition

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phenomena is impermanent. There is not like, condition, phenomena should be impermanent. It is it's opening to impermanent it's not, not trying to, to, to project this idea on to live but it's a different using your intuitive mind, isn't it, you open you watch you listen, you pay attention. And then you're aware of the changing this. And you're aware of even your own compulsive attitude, like, being aware of this compulsive feeling is something I got to do, how to do it. And being aware of that, that awareness of that feeling of that compulsive feeling or aware, the attitude that I thought was being quite honest and realistic that I'm not that I am, you know, I'm personally with a lot of faults and weaknesses. And then in order to become an enlightened being, I've got to, you know, get over these and, and get rid of them in some way and become an arahant. So then, this is how the mind works. And this is how it's often in how you read it into the scripture. But in in terms of reflective awareness in when you when you really notice what that that is something you've created in your mind. I am a person with a lot of faults and weaknesses. And I've got to practice hard in order to overcome them. That's something I'm creating. In my mind, I'm creating that, that attitude. I create that that doesn't, that's not that's not the truth. That is the creation and that which is a aware of that, then you start beginning to, to know the difference between the awakened state of being and what you create, into your mind through habit, through attachment. Like in listening, the one who knows when like, we use this puto, or the name Buddha itself is, is a significant word because it is putting us into that they pointing to a state of attention of knowing directly, of intuitive awareness of wisdom

Ajahn Sumedho 25:44
so, there's no personally, you know, it's a, you know, if you start thinking, I'm Buddha than that, you know, that coming from personality again, and then did the thinking I'm, I am the Buddha and that's another that doesn't work. When we call refuge in Buddha, or poo tongues are none Khatami gives us a, that's a kind of convention too. But it points to a reality that we can begin to trust in which is awareness is the Buddha is the puto, the one who know that which knows, which is awake and aware, and is awakened as it's not. It's not judgment, judgmental, critical. The Buddha isn't saying you should be like this, and you shouldn't be like that, and, and all that it's, it's knowing that the can all condition phenomena is, is like this, it's changing. Well, sometimes we brought up like, a brought up in religion like Christianity, where God tells you what you should be. And at least this is my, my, the way I was taught, you know, how you should be a good boy. And, and that every time you're bad, you hurt God's feelings as product. If I told a lie, you know, God would be very, you know, disappointed in me. And, hence, Oh, you, you you know, this is kind of a moral training as, as a child, really, it's what your parents think, isn't that, who you is, it's all mixed up with parent perception of parents and, and God at the kind of parent parental figure.

Ajahn Sumedho 27:47
So awaken this then isn't, is is, is learning to listen. And it trusts in in just the most simple state of being. It's not like jhana or, or absorption in anything. It's it's pure attention. And so it is pure it's so if you trust in this purity, then there are no false impurity is there. It's perfect. There's no if it's pure, there's no impurities. So this is where the trust in this in this attentiveness to the present. Because once you once you try to find it, it's pure, you know, you try is there any then you start going into doubt? You know, so don't don't trust it rather than think about it. This in the imminent act of being away, attentive in this moment. And when I do this, then my mind relaxes into this I hear the sound of silence and then there's there's no self there's purity, there's no self and if I start feeling now the conditions arise, right? I should

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be doing say I'm aware of it. I'm aware of it as a condition the day the V Parker comma, of having been through the American educational system and giving myself to this incredibly compulsive way of doing of living one's life. So it'd be fun to come arises, you know, you should be in shouldn't be and all that, but in this in this state of purity and pure attention It's not personal, I'm not saying I'm pure now, Hudgins tomatoes pure, it's beyond that. It's not it's not a personal you're not talking about it in any personal way, but it's a recognition or realization. It's what you really are, it's the true nature of things. It's not not a creation, I'm not creating a purity I'm not kind of creating an ideal of it and then deluding myself with it. But this is where it is trusting because because your your personal personality view is not going to trust it. Personnel is going to come and say nothing about you, you know, you just had some dirty thoughts and and you were you know, really looking pretty you know, we really feeling pretty upset and angry about something somebody said to you the other day in what kind of you can't You're certainly full of impurities you know, you're not for all these years you're still filled with impurities and this is the old inner tyrant this is the the personality view personality view is the is the Tyrant is the is the victim is the victimizer it's poor me I'm so impure and it's the accuser you are not good enough you're impure it's both you can't trust it don't take don't take refuge in being a victim or or am being victimizer that you can trust in this awakened awareness

Ajahn Sumedho 32:03
and that trust is humbling it doesn't it isn't like believing in something when it's it's learning to relax and be trust in in just the ability to just be here and open and receptive to this whatever is happening now even if what's happening is unpleasant or nasty or whatever the conditions you're experiencing are the present is not the not that's not a problem, if you trust in this impurity

Ajahn Sumedho 32:44
like trying to like with the Vineya for example, the Nandi project keep the video pure and and because the whole personality view attaches to even the Vineya Am I pure enough in this in my opinion is purer than somebody else's or not it's pure and and on and on like that then he never if you're just using this this this convention to to increase the sense of personal worth are worthless if you think you're more pure than the rat and that's arrogant holier than thou and then if you think you're always into your eye then you know you're gonna get feel hopeless you know you can't do it better they're going going get drunk or something nice forget about it for a while relax them Oh even then beating yourself up by your ideals have not been pure enough

Ajahn Sumedho 34:06
conventions themselves are limited you know they're there their nature is imperfect and changing so in again our convention you know maybe expect even the convention to be perfect. And then when you you know then you become after a while you you can become very critical of the convention because you can see flaws in it or it isn't you know, doesn't isn't as good as you thought or some of it isn't doesn't make sense or things like this. But recognize that the convention isn't you know, it's it's it's Anita do cannot and just like every other convention but it is a convention based on the morality of doing good and refrain from doing evil with actions speech. Say it's an agree way of living where we agree to take responsibility for how we live in this planet, on this society the convention we have like Tera Vaada Buddhism is, you know, you can find many things you may not like or, or find all that agreeable to you when. But it is a it is a tradition, there's a lot of power from being so old and ancient and still useful

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notes still a viable tradition that works. I mean, it's, it's, you know, so it has its you know, it's not a matter of, of it having to be perfect for us to use but learning to use it for awakened awareness.

Ajahn Sumedho 36:00
Then we get into the old Buddhist conic, like the Mahayana and then Badri Yana and then you and Hina Yana and then you were were considered Heaney Yana, lesser vehicle may think that means it's probably not as good. My honor is better logic, isn't it? Less a vehicle and greater vehicle in Badri Yana, and that's their absolute the best, you can't get better than Bhadra according to the Tibetans that's the highest vehicle until that, then we we thought and thinking in terms of good better bass. And these, but all of these are convention, you know, whether you call it my honor, Hina Yana Adriano, their conventions, they're limited, they're, they're, you know, they're, they're imperfect, they're functional, then, you know, to use them, because they, for mindfulness rather than for some kind of attachment or, or position that one takes on anything. So they can be very divisive if we attach to Tera Vaada. And then we start looking down on every other form of Buddhism, men reading there, my honor, they're not, they're not the pure, they're not the original. They're higher or greater, but not original. And then we can get arrogant because we've, we've got our own way of justifying our convention. But this is all just in plain with word isn't it? When you look right and what's going on, if you're just creating Mahayana Hina yarnover Adriaan in your mind, because the know and the refuges in Buddha, not in these jhanas and these and the Buddha he knows lead every thought anything is is is you know in changing and non self so trust in that in the simplicity of that rather than because if you don't then you're going to it is going to rouse your old compulsive habits of thinking I've got to do more I've got to develop this I've got to become a bodhisattva I've got to get the higher practice going I've got to an unknown like that. And so he just the whole when we when you're caught in that conventional realm and that's all you know, then you then you're easily intimidated and blinded by all the gasoline kind of positions in attitudes and ideas that people can throw it you know, this is where trusting in awareness and then you not a matter of having the best but I have a feeling that maybe you should have the something better than what you have that's in the creation of your mind, isn't it when you establish library in terms of what is adequate, like in rank for monasticism? Buddhist monasticism is not based on on having the best, but on what adequate are the four requisites adequate you don't have to be the best you don't have to have the best food and the best robes and all that. But adequate, good enough can it begin? Is it survival? Is there any problem in play in your having a place to stay or medicine for sickness doesn't have to be at the very best. But it's in fact that the standard is oftentimes established at the lowest point, you know, like rag robes rather than then silk robes

Ajahn Sumedho 40:23
then the the dama dama Vineya is is respected and taught. So, these are, these are things that are very, you know, which give us a sense of whether, you know, the, you know, it's place we can, we can live standards are placed at the best, you know, it has to be the very best but if the dumber is taught, and the Vineya is respected, the four requisites are adequate, it's good enough. So go for go for the practice rather than and then quibble around the rest. Know, whether you like the teacher or not, or whether you you know, it's better to use the, the awareness to develop awareness rather than to, to go along with one's feelings of criticism or doubt problems in the, with dealing with the people in the place you're in

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Ajahn Sumedho 41:43
I was, you know, just contemplated in myself, this this compulsive attitudes, until I really could see it, you know, God through my must. And it's very insidious, because it's so it wasn't, you know, just, you know, one time off inside many it was reminded myself of how, you know, how this is a monad how I approach life in general, full of should then feelings I've got, there's something I've got to do, I shouldn't be doing something, or I shouldn't. And just noticing listening to this, and learning to relax and trust in the refuge, which is very humbling, because it doesn't seem like anything. It's not like, you know, doesn't it seems like it's not worth anything and it doesn't seem like anything much. So, is the attention in the present though what I want something I shouldn't be doing, you know, tell me what to do next. How many hours should I be sitting? How many hours should I be walking? And what should I be developing should I do more meta and add more like this because because we want something to do and we feel very LEDs when there's nothing to do nowhere to go. So, in like in monastic life, we do offer structure and then you have conventions and structures you have a you know, morning puja evening Pooja, and you've got fortnightly recitations and so forth. So, you have a form conventional form to you is you know, to do something and then we chant aim and and Binda, Bata and all these things are our, you know, some part of a, of a tradition gives a bit from these, these, this, this this structure, it's to help us to compare like sealer for behavior and the structure for for a community or they when people go on self retreat, then they they kind of let go the structure then they're thrown thrown onto their own. You know, and how, what happens when you throw out left on your own and, you know, nobody knows what you're doing. So you don't have to kind of look around see if senior monks looking at you and on and on like that, you know, you're left to your own device. So you could sleep all day or you could you know read novels or or go for long walks and or you could you know really practice hard and or you know you're all different range of possibilities is left up to you and to notice that feeling of you know when that's when the structure is removed what what happened

Ajahn Sumedho 45:38
and not in a judgmental way like that bring back the shirt and I should practice so many hours a day sit so many hours walk so many hours and and do this and do that in order to you know, get my practice get my Samadhi and really get somewhere in my practice and that they're not that that's wrong but that that can be you know, that's that's also maybe a very compulsive thing and when and if you don't live up to it then what do you feel like you know, you feel guilt ridden if you don't do what you've determined to do, and to notice what you know how we will how the mind works and awaken to it

Ajahn Sumedho 46:40
it's easy enough everybody, if you have a strong leader that says the now you do this, you do that you everybody come everybody leave and everybody you know marching step and and the more than this this is good training Aldhelm

Ajahn Sumedho 47:14
but that also brings up know some people that don't like it then they thought they resisting that rebelling against it or other people love it because they can't they don't know what to do if they're if nobody's telling them what to do next

Ajahn Sumedho 47:37

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and operate like the security of everything controlled and in everything held together by a strong leader. But recognize that this monastic life The thing is his for awakening and strong leader or nobody else can make you do it, you know, I can kind of browbeat you into conformity you know, get heavy and they kind of browbeat you into or manipulate you emotionally by saying if you really want to please me you will do this if you really want my approval I won't give you my approval if you don't behave properly and things like this then I can kind of use my you know emotional power to try to control and manipulate the situation but that's that not something that you know is is skillful that's not what we're here for. The the onus is on each one of us isn't it is waking up and in only that, that but don't think I have to wake up because John tomatoes but learning to, to recognize and appreciate in yourself just a simple imminent act of attention. open, relaxed listening, being here and now just learning to to to recognize that to appreciate that more and more interested because you're emotionally probably programmed for the other than you should and you shouldn't

Ajahn Sumedho 49:45
so wanting to to give, you know, an occasion and situation. Opportunity, encouragement All this is you know, like, like, what we're trying to do here just you know give the a situation where you're encouraged to trust in this and to cultivate this way and when they say cultivate, they're not that that's not like having to do anything it's learning more to relax and trust in being the flow of life because we know you know life is like this and so, so Life Changes You know, you can see this in the past year how the changes Amravati from it building and and opening ceremony and all that kind of Amiens around that and now it's it's that that periods over it's changed different like this remember, you know, just in with what pop home just feeling when I first went there it was, it was such a kind of a spree decor, you know, we were really there with Lumpur Cha is only 22 months and we were you know, we were really getting somewhere and we were really cracked troops top grade top guns. And then few years later, you notice the same things I didn't like and and getting very critical of it and thinking it's all falling apart. And then I saw her fall apart with Lumpur Cha when he had his stroke you remember going to two years after he had his stroke going to what pop pong and wiper polling they had the inner monastery where the monks they and then they they had an outer part where they had a special kind of cootie set up for them control which was loud for nursing care and all kinds of things and then they had an outer Salah where people can say you go to the outer Salah and nobody was nobody wanted to come to the monastery they only came to see who's Lumpur Cha who was ill and couldn't talk or do anything all the emphasis was in the his cootie and and then no monks wanted to live there and and I remember going in there only three months one time in the huge monastery now generally when through others and the place was looking pretty shabby it was usually speaking span and clean and you know the standards of order were very high there anything with sweeping the paths and and repairing everything and then then you go in there's like a ghost towel. You know just the cooties empty cooties that need repairing and dirty and dusty and the pads not swept until fourth now remember some Bangkok people coming to me and say no it's no good anymore Anjan Liam can't teach he's known and they complain they say we want you to come back and be the abbot picky nice and go back and and take over that they wanted you know they people were just you know really you know whether it had changed in a way that they just felt it shouldn't be like that

Ajahn Sumedho 54:01

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but in but now it's back into its face you know 50 months and and it's all you know it's all operating in full capacity but I mean it's changes things change now we opened a chain we're not demanding that it changed in any way that we want it or or that when it's at its peak that we can can keep it that peak it's impossible so that and even in yourself you know you to be aware when you're at your best when your worst when you're you're feeling really good and inspired and love the live when you when you're feeling down and despairing, lonely and depressed and heartened these are the This awareness is your ref here where the changing this feeling of attitude of have mood but material change of emotional change and stay with that because a refuge is indestructible you know it's not something that changes it it's something you can it's a refuge you can trust him but then refuge is not something you create it's not a creation it's not an ideal it's it's very practical and very simple but but easily overlook or not notice so when when you're mindful you're beginning to notice like this like when I remind myself this is this is this is pure this moment

Ajahn Sumedho 56:01
like and I really make a note of this this is this is this is the path this is purity not not not anything I'm creating but this this this is state of attention of relaxed not attention like a tune, but more like relaxed attention listening open, receptive and then as you relax into that, then you you know, it's a natural state, not a creative state it's not it's not dependent on on conditions making it that way. It's just we forget it there's a problem we forget it all the times that we go get thrown back into the old habits every time and this is why was my issue remembering it more trusting that more then it's cultivating cultivating this in this way of just leading yourself back all the time right to this, this this awareness and then you get carried away in and then regarding again and keep doing that and and no matter how we calcitonin or difficult or wild your your emotions and thoughts may be all right, no, this this is this this is what this is the refuge and to apply that to everything, you know, like like being personally wounded like like when somebody says something very hurtful or a question what is it that gets hurt if somebody insults me or or abuses me in some way I feel hurt I feel misunderstood and I feel offended and annoyed or even angry what is it that gets angry and annoyed and gets offended you know it's is that anything is that my refuge that which is feelings get hurt and gets offended gets upset. If I'm in this refuge, the refuge never gets upset by anything in calling anything you want but as a person then I can be easily upset as a person he can upset me very easily so I mean because personality that's I can do it like that, you know based on you know me is worthwhile are worthy of being you know appreciated or not appreciated in being understood properly or misunderstood or respected or not respected enough for you know, all this kind of thing and just then my personality is the Eagles. Oh, am I'm just no wide open, to be hurt, to be offended to be upset by anything. But that's not my read. My personality is not my refuge. Not what I would advise as being a refuge because it if your personnel is anything like mine

Ajahn Sumedho 1:00:01
I wouldn't for a minute monda recommend even you taking refuge in my prison now but in awareness yeah because awareness is pure and it doesn't you know if you trust it more and more than you're even though you're feeling hurt and upset and and disrespected and unloved and unappreciated, the awareness knows that is a Nietzche it's not judging is not making any promises, fully accepting the feeling of nobody loves me everybody hates me being lame. And that goes it goes away naturally it dropped because its nature is changed. So this evening, we have this is the the midnight hour, isn't it?

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Ajahn Sumedho 1:01:10
Everybody's invited to join the observer observing

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